

# THE MIDNIGHT VISITOR LOG — PODCAST

## Episode 01: "The Mothman: A Retrospective"

### Lithium Dreams Industries

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#### EPISODE METADATA

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Episode Number: 001  
Title: The Mothman: A Retrospective  
Estimated Runtime: 26-30 minutes (with sponsor breaks)  
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#### CHAPTER LIST:

00:00 Intro / Welcome  
01:30 The Place — Point Pleasant, WV  
08:00 SPONSOR BREAK 1  
08:45 The Wave — Sightings 1966-1967  
18:30 SPONSOR BREAK 2  
19:15 The Bridge — Science Break  
23:30 Theory Break  
30:00 The Open Door — Chicago Flap  
40:00 Outro  
42:00 End Credits / CTA

#### PODCAST FEED DESCRIPTION:

Forty-six people went into the Ohio River on December 15th, 1967.  
For thirteen months before that, something had been watching the town.

In Episode 1 of The Midnight Visitor Log, we go to Point Pleasant, West Virginia — the original Mothman flap of 1966-1967, the Silver Bridge collapse, the three major theories, and the Chicago wave of 2017 that nobody talks about as much as they should. Law enforcement. Airline workers. 160 documented sightings across the Upper Midwest. Fifty years after Point Pleasant.

Facts-first. Mystery-honoring. Filed after closing at the Last Roadside Attraction.

#### TAGS:

mothman, point pleasant, silver bridge, paranormal, cryptid, west virginia, chicago mothman, john keel, urban legend, folklore, weird america, true strange, midnight visitor log, LDI

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## — CHAPTER 0: INTRO —

[MUSIC IN — atmospheric theme, low. The kind of music that sounds like driving at night.]

[MUSIC UNDER]

Welcome to The Midnight Visitor Log.

I'm your host, and this is the podcast edition of the show that lives on Lithium Dreams TV — the YouTube channel and the actual physical museum exhibit at the Last Roadside Attraction. If you found this through a podcast feed and you've never heard of us before: welcome. You landed on a good one to start with.

Here's what this show is. Every episode, I take one case — one creature, one event, one unexplained chapter of the American record — and I go through it. All of it. The facts. The witnesses. The science. The theories. I don't tell you what to think. I'm not here to convince you. I'm here to show you what happened and let you take it home.

Tonight is Episode 1. And it's the Mothman.

[MUSIC FADES UNDER NARRATION — ambient bed continues low]

## — CHAPTER 1: COLD OPEN —

Okay. So.

There's a man in West Virginia who, on November 14th, 1966, watched his dog run into the dark after a pair of glowing red eyes — and that dog never came home.

[PAUSE]

That same week, about four miles outside of a small river town called Point Pleasant, four people in a car — two couples, nobody on anything, filed a police report that same night — said a gray figure with ten-foot wings and red eyes kept pace with their car on the highway.

At over a hundred miles per hour. Just gliding.

Now listen. I know what that sounds like. You've heard stories like that your whole life. You're already filing it. You already know where the folder is.

Here's the part you maybe don't know.

For thirteen months after that first sighting, this thing — the Mothman, they called it, because a Batman-obsessed newspaper editor thought he was being clever — appeared all over Mason County, West Virginia. More than two dozen documented accounts. People on their way to work. Cemetery workers. A woman who dropped her baby, she was so frightened. All of them describing the same thing.

And on December 15th, 1967 — a Friday evening, five days before Christmas — a bridge collapsed into the Ohio River and took forty-six people with it.

That's the Silver Bridge. That's a real disaster. Real families.

[PAUSE]

And the Mothman? Stopped showing up that night. Not gradually. Not fewer and fewer reports trailing off. It just — stopped.

So tonight on Midnight Visitor Logs, we are doing the whole thing. Point Pleasant 1966. The bridge engineering — I actually read the NTSB report, it's fascinating — the three major theories, the witnesses who deserve to have their names said out loud, and then the part that really got me: the Chicago flap of 2017, fifty years later, fifteen hundred miles north, where over fifty-five people including law enforcement and airline personnel reported the same creature in one calendar year.

I have been waiting to do this episode.

Let's get into it.

[MUSIC SWELL — brief. Then under.]

## — CHAPTER 2: THE PLACE —

[AMBIENT BED — low hum, slightly industrial. A place with history in the ground.]

Point Pleasant, West Virginia.

Population around 4,000 in 1966. Sits right on the Ohio River. The kind of town where everybody knows everybody, where people have roots three and four generations deep, where you don't lock your car because there's no real reason to.

It's a good town. Genuinely good people.

But north of town — about four miles up the road — there's a place that was never quite right.

During World War II, the federal government built a massive munitions plant on 8,300 acres of Mason County farmland. They called it the West Virginia Ordnance Works. The locals just called it the TNT Area.

They made TNT there. Tons and tons of it. Enough to help win a war.

When the war ended, the plant shut down. And the land just... sat there.

The buildings were abandoned. The underground storage igloos — these squat concrete bunkers dug into the hillside, dozens of them — they stayed. Contaminated soil. Toxic runoff draining into the wetlands. The government eventually handed the land over for use as a wildlife management area.

Wildlife management. On land that had been soaked in industrial chemicals for years.

I say all of that because it matters. Before a single person saw a single unexplainable thing, the TNT Area was already a strange place. Restricted. Remote. Chemically compromised. At night,

it was genuinely unsettling — just the shape of the place, the darkness, the old industrial bones of it.

If something was going to show up somewhere and not be believed, it was going to be there.

Or — depending on how you look at it — if something was already there, and the land had always been wrong, maybe that's why.

[AMBIENT BED SHIFTS — slightly quieter, more open. A sense of the land.]

The fall of 1966.

Something was coming.

The first hint of it came in August, a full three months before the legend officially started. A Point Pleasant man named Lawrence Gray said a six-foot glowing figure appeared inside his home on Jefferson Avenue. Described it as dirty gray and white, almost lunar in color. Said he felt paralyzed and couldn't move. Lasted less than a minute. Then it was gone.

Nobody outside his neighborhood knew about it.

On November 1st, a National Guardsman at the Camp Conley Road armory reported seeing a large brown humanoid figure perched in a tree near the facility. He didn't report it officially. It surfaced later, after everything else happened.

The world wasn't watching yet. But something was already there.

[AMBIENT BED OUT]

[SPONSOR BREAK 1]

*[This is a good place for a first break — we've set the scene, we're about to get into the sightings. Natural breath.]*

### — CHAPTER 3: THE WAVE —

[MUSIC IN — tempo slightly higher. We're moving now.]

[MUSIC UNDER then OUT]

November 12th, 1966. Clendenin, West Virginia.

Five men are digging a grave at a cemetery. It's afternoon. They're not drunk, they're not teenagers, they're not looking for a story — they're doing a job nobody wants to do on a weekday afternoon.

A man named Kenneth Duncan looks up and sees a brown, manlike figure with wings emerge from the trees and glide low over their heads.

Some of the other men see it. Some don't. It's gone before anyone can react.

Three days later, on November 14th — a different kind of strange.

A man named Merle Partridge is watching TV in Salem, West Virginia, about 90 miles from Point Pleasant. His television screen fills with a strange pattern — like interference, but patterned, not random. A high-pitched whine comes out of the speakers.

His German Shepherd, a dog named Bandit, starts howling toward the barn.

Merle shines a flashlight outside and sees two red lights — circular, close together — in the field behind his house. Reflecting back like bicycle reflectors. Or like eyes.

Bandit ran toward those lights.

Bandit never came back.

[PAUSE]

I've thought about that a lot. The dog.

You know what's interesting about a dog? A dog doesn't have a cultural template for monsters. A dog doesn't know what the newspaper said. A dog just reacts to what it encounters.

Bandit ran toward something. And didn't come back.

[PAUSE]

November 15th, 1966. This is the night everything changes.

Two young couples — Roger and Linda Scarberry, and Steve and Mary Mallette — are driving through the TNT Area late at night. No particular reason. Just driving, the way young people in small towns do.

Near the abandoned North Power Plant, they see something standing near the road.

Large. Gray. Something between a man and a bird. Wings folded against its body. And eyes — large, circular, red — glowing in their headlights.

They turned the car around and drove toward Point Pleasant as fast as that car would go. They said the creature spread its wings — ten feet across, maybe more — and flew after them.

And it kept up.

Not a little bit. It kept up with them on Route 62 at over a hundred miles an hour, according to Roger Scarberry. Just gliding. Not even flapping.

Now. I want to be honest with you here.

People misremember things. Adrenaline does funny things to perception. Roger Scarberry may have been doing 70 miles an hour and felt like 100. That's real. That's how humans work.

But here's the thing.

There were four of them. In the car at the same time. Four people who all said the same thing. Who went to the Mason County Sheriff's office that night — not the next morning, that night — and who filed a report.

The next day, the Point Pleasant Register published the story.

A newspaper sub-editor, looking for a catchy name — it was 1966, the Batman TV show was huge — called it "Moth Man."

The name was a joke. A pop culture reference. A subeditor on deadline.

And somehow that name stuck to the thing for the next fifty years.

[AMBIENT BED IN — low, steady]

After November 16th, the flap was open. Reports started coming in.

One more person saw something they couldn't name.

Marcella Bennett, November 16th. She went with the Wamsley family to visit a friend near the TNT Area housing. When they pulled up, a figure rose from behind a parked car.

The witnesses described it as having wings drawn in toward its body, legs that looked like a man's, a head tilted sideways and set low in the shoulders — like there was no neck. Over six feet tall.

Marcella Bennett was so frightened that she dropped her infant daughter.

The baby was fine. But that detail stays with me.

[PAUSE]

One more person saw something they couldn't name.

November 21st. Richard West, in Charleston — 50 miles east of Point Pleasant. Saw a six-foot figure with red eyes and a wingspan of six to eight feet. Sitting on the roof of a building.

He said it flew straight upward. Like a helicopter. Vertical, with no runway, no run-up. Just up.

[PAUSE]

One more person saw something they couldn't name.

November 27th. Connie Jo Carpenter, Route 33, near New Haven. She described a seven-foot gray figure with glowing red eyes. Said it unfolded ten-foot wings and came at her car.

After the encounter, Connie developed severe eye irritation — a kind of conjunctivitis. She didn't know why. She hadn't been near chemicals or anything unusual, just that road and that thing.

[PAUSE]

One more person saw something they couldn't name.

Tom Ury, November 25th, Route 62. Very large bird. Wingspan he estimated at ten to twelve feet. Circled his car and kept pace with him on the road.

I'll give you Tom Ury's account straight, because Tom Ury deserves credit: he later said he believed he saw a very large bird. Not a monster. A bird. He was one of the few witnesses who downgraded his account over time.

That kind of honesty doesn't make the sightings more or less real. But it matters.

[AMBIENT BED OUT]

By the end of November 1966, the wave had spread across at least four states. West Virginia, Ohio, Kentucky, Pennsylvania. Reports from the TNT Area. Reports from rooftops in Charleston. Reports from the highway.

The West Virginia Encyclopedia eventually counted roughly 26 documented sightings in that first cluster. John Keel — a journalist and UFO investigator who came to Point Pleasant to cover the story — counted more.

For thirteen months, this went on.

And then.

[PAUSE — a long one. Let the silence sit.]

December 15th, 1967.

It was a Friday evening. Cold. The Christmas rush was on. The Silver Bridge between Point Pleasant and Gallipolis was packed with cars — 64 people in 32 vehicles, moving across that span.

At approximately 5:00 in the afternoon, observers on both banks heard a sound described as "like a shotgun."

And the bridge started to go.

One witness said it "just keeled over, starting slowly on the Ohio side and then folding like a deck of cards to the West Virginia side."

In seconds, 64 people were in the Ohio River.

Forty-six of them didn't come out.

[PAUSE]

I want to stop here for a minute.

Those were real people. Real families. It was five days before Christmas. Some of them were probably on their way to do what all of us do the week before the holiday — get groceries, pick up kids, stop by someone's house.

Forty-six people.

The Silver Bridge collapse is one of the worst infrastructure disasters in American history. And it changed how the country thinks about bridge inspection permanently. After December 15th,

1967, the federal government required systematic inspection of all bridges nationwide.

That's the real legacy of that day.

What happened in the water — the rescue crews, the search, the grief — that's what Point Pleasant carried.

And the Mothman?

On December 15th, 1967, the sightings stopped.

No gradual fade. No lingering reports. No "one more person."

Silence.

[SPONSOR BREAK 2]

*[Natural break — the bridge has just fallen, the sightings have stopped. A moment of stillness before the science section. Perfect spot.]*

#### — CHAPTER 4: THE BRIDGE — SCIENCE BREAK —

[MUSIC IN — slightly more clinical, deliberate. Like a documentary transition.]

[MUSIC OUT]

Here is what the National Transportation Safety Board determined, after three years of investigation.

The Silver Bridge failed because of a crack in a single piece of steel called eyebar number 330.

An eyebar is essentially a long, flat steel bar with holes at each end — like a giant paper clip link. The Silver Bridge used chains of these eyebars to bear the load of the roadway. Each link in the chain was made of just two eyebars.

Two.

The investigators found that the design itself was fragile in a specific way: if one eyebar failed, the other couldn't carry the load. There was no redundancy. If you lose one, you lose both. And if you lose both, the chain goes.

The crack in eyebar 330 had been growing for years. Stress corrosion. Corrosion fatigue. The crack was on the inside surface of the eyebar's hole — a place that was physically impossible to inspect without taking the bridge apart.

The crack that killed 46 people was smaller than your thumbnail.

[PAUSE]

I want you to sit with that for a second.



A crack smaller than your thumbnail. Growing invisibly, in an inaccessible place, for years. The bridge looked completely normal from every angle anyone could see. People drove across it every day. Including on December 15th.

That's not metaphor. That's engineering.

The failure was real, and it was mechanical, and it was preventable — not because someone should have seen the crack, because they couldn't have — but because the design should never have used only two eyebars per link. Three bars and one failure wouldn't have cascaded. The math was always there.

Now.

Does that mechanical explanation account for everything that happened in Point Pleasant between November 1966 and December 1967?

[PAUSE]

No. It doesn't.

The NTSB tells us why the bridge fell. It doesn't say anything about the thirteen months of sightings that preceded it. It doesn't explain why the sightings stopped the same night.

Those are two separate facts that happen to share a calendar.

What you do with that — that's yours.

## — CHAPTER 5: THEORY BREAK —

[AMBIENT BED IN — neutral, listening-room quality. Like a late-night conversation.]

Alright. So I've got three theories written out here, and I want to walk you through all of them, because they're each a lot smarter than the headline version.

[PAUSE — lighter, self-aware]

I will tell you — I have been doing research for this episode for about three weeks. My wife came into the office and looked at my corkboard and just — left without saying anything. I have a whole section pinned up on the eyobar chain design of suspension bridges from 1927. I found a 1975 paperback copy of John Keel's *The Mothman Prophecies* at a used bookstore in Peoria, which I will tell you is exactly the right way to read that book. I'm not saying I'm normal about this. I'm just saying I'm thorough. Okay. The theories.

[AMBIENT BED UNDER — stay through theory section]

"Alright, here's the comfortable one — and it's not as dumb as you think."

This is the most comfortable explanation. And honestly, it's not a bad one.

Wildlife biologist Robert L. Smith at West Virginia University said pretty quickly in 1966 that the Mothman was almost certainly a Sandhill Crane — a bird that can stand nearly as tall as a

full-grown adult, has a wingspan over seven feet, and has red flesh patches around its eyes that would absolutely glow in headlights.

Joe Nickell, an investigator with the Committee for Skeptical Inquiry, made a case for the Barred Owl. Large, nocturnal, silent, deep black eyes with strong eyeshine, known for startling people in the dark.

Both are credible. Both are real birds that exist, that people encounter, that look genuinely alarming if you're not expecting them.

But.

The Sandhill Crane was not native to West Virginia in 1966. One crane doesn't explain 26 sightings across four states. And multiple witnesses described the creature standing upright, on two legs, like a man — which is not how cranes move. And no crane can keep pace with a car at highway speed. And cranes do not fly straight upward off of rooftops.

I'm not dismissing the bird theory. I think it probably explains some of what was reported. But I don't think it explains all of it.

Here's what the scientists say. And here's the thing they don't say: they can't explain why it stopped.

[PAUSE]

"The second one is the one skeptics love. They're not entirely wrong."

The basic argument goes like this: the Scarberry-Mallette sighting was probably a real animal, seen under bad conditions, by frightened people, in a place that was already unsettling. The newspaper published the story and gave the thing a name. And from that moment on, Point Pleasant was primed.

Every shadow became wings. Every reflection became eyes. Every owl became the Mothman. Confirmation bias, expectant attention, and the social pressure to have seen what everyone else was seeing — these are real psychological forces, and they can generate wave after wave of reported sightings without any actual phenomenon driving them.

And here's the thing about mass hysteria: it follows a pattern. Triggering event, media amplification, escalating reports, climactic event, sudden cessation.

Which is exactly what happened in Point Pleasant.

But.

Some of the Point Pleasant sightings preceded the newspaper coverage. The August sighting. The November 1st armory sighting. The November 12th cemetery sighting — that one was three days before the Scarberrys saw anything.

The Chicago wave — which we'll get to — happened in a metropolitan area of millions of people, in 2017, where there was no Point Pleasant-style media saturation around a local Mothman legend before the sightings started.

Mass hysteria requires a shared cultural template. The Chicago witnesses weren't sharing one.

I'm not here to tell you what to think. I'm here to show you what happened and let you take it home.

[PAUSE]

"And then there's the third one. This is where it gets weird. Bear with me."

This is John Keel's territory.

Keel came to Point Pleasant in late 1966 as a journalist and skeptic. He left a believer in something — though not in extraterrestrials, which is interesting, because people assume that's where the story goes.

Keel said the entities he encountered — the Mothman, the strange phone callers, the men in black who followed him, the people who gave him eerie accurate information — were not from another planet. They were from something he called the superspectrum. A layer of reality that overlaps ours but operates by different rules. What he called ultraterrestrials.

His theory was that these intelligences have always been here. That in medieval times we saw them as demons and angels. In the early 20th century we saw them as fairies. In the 1950s we started seeing them as flying saucers. In 1966 they were a winged man with red eyes.

The form changes. The presence doesn't.

[PAUSE]

Now. I want to be transparent with you about Keel, because this is a case where the messenger complicates the message.

There's strong evidence that some of the phone calls Keel received from mysterious entities were actually pranks placed by another UFO researcher named Gray Barker. Barker later admitted to some of it. Keel also published his book in 1975 — eight years after the events — and some critics argue he reshaped the narrative with the benefit of hindsight.

So. Take Keel with some care.

But also — the witnesses weren't Keel. Marcella Bennett wasn't Keel. Connie Carpenter wasn't Keel. The four couples in the car weren't Keel.

The witnesses are the witnesses, whatever we think of the man who wrote the book about them.

I don't know what they saw. But I know every single one of them described the same eyes.

[AMBIENT BED OUT]

## — CHAPTER 6: THE OPEN DOOR —

[MUSIC IN — map-expanding energy. Something that sounds like distance being covered.]

[MUSIC UNDER then OUT]

Here's where it gets genuinely interesting to me.

2011. Chicago, Illinois.

Fifty years after Point Pleasant. Fifteen hundred miles north. A city of 2.7 million people, not a small Appalachian river town. Satellites overhead, cameras everywhere, one of the busiest airports in the world.

A paranormal investigator named Lon Strickler, based in Pennsylvania, starts receiving reports through his research blog. Reports of a large, dark, winged humanoid figure gliding low over roadways, rivers, and industrial zones at night.

He logs them. Quietly. There aren't many at first.

Then 2017 happens.

By the end of 2017, Lon Strickler and the Mutual UFO Network had documented over 55 individual sightings in the Chicago metropolitan area in a single year.

Fifty-five.

That's the most concentrated cluster of this type of report since 1966 in Point Pleasant.

And I want to tell you who was seeing it.

Not teenagers on a back road. Law enforcement officers. Airline personnel. Truck drivers. Healthcare workers. Families. People who, in many cases, filed their reports anonymously because they were afraid of professional consequences.

Let me read you a few of these.

[AMBIENT BED IN — urban night sound, very low. Just texture.]

April 15th, 2017. Lake Michigan, about two miles offshore near Montrose Avenue. A woman is out on a boat with her husband and two other couples, celebrating a friend's birthday.

She looks up.

"I happen to look up and saw what looked like a giant bat — and not like a fox bat, which I looked up and saw was the biggest bat. This bat was as tall as my husband, who is 6-foot, 4-inches, or even bigger. It was solid black with eyes that seemed to reflect the moonlight. This bat was blacker than the surrounding night sky and was perfectly silhouetted against the moonlit sky."

It circled the boat three times in complete silence.

Then it flew off toward Montrose.

About five minutes later, she saw a brilliant green light moving along the horizon above the lake.

"After the object was out of sight, we sat there looking around in stunned silence. I began feeling this overwhelming sensation of dread and told my husband that I felt that it was prudent that we get off the water as quickly as possible."

[PAUSE]

Thirty minutes later, 10:30 PM. A group of men are hanging out near North Avenue.

"We heard what sounded like a bird flapping its wings. One of my friends yelled out that he saw a huge Lechuza over by the road. We walked over there and saw what looked like a big owl. As we walked up on it, this owl stood up on two feet and looked right at us. We saw what looked like a huge Lechuza, except it was about six feet tall and really big. It had large glowing red eyes that were completely freaking everybody out."

It flew off toward North Avenue.

[PAUSE]

Two a.m. A warehouse worker arrives for his shift at the Chicago International Produce Market near Damen Avenue. Sees a group of his coworkers standing in the parking lot, looking up.

"I looked up and saw the biggest freaking owl I have ever seen. I'm 6-foot, 2-inches, and I'm guessing this thing was at least a foot taller than me. It was completely black except for it having bright yellowish/reddish eyes like a cat.

It stood there for a minute or two staring at everyone before shooting up into the sky and disappearing. It made this sound as it took off and flew away that sounded like a truck's brakes when they are burned out.

It stood upright like a man. Just really, really tall.

I don't imagine anyone would believe me anyways."

[AMBIENT BED OUT]

[PAUSE — a real one]

That last line.

"I don't imagine anyone would believe me anyways."

That's a man who saw something. That's a man who knows how it sounds. That's not someone who wants attention — if he wanted attention, he'd have put his name on it.

He filed it anonymously. He went back to work.

The sightings kept coming. And they kept clustering around O'Hare International Airport.

November 2019. A truck driver picking up a cargo shipment from the O'Hare cargo area describes a tall, birdlike entity standing in the shadows outside the perimeter fence. A person with wings, he said, stretched out and flapping.

February 2020. An airport security officer, on a routine cigarette break near the perimeter fence, sees a massive black winged creature standing in the shadows. When it turns toward him, he sees the red eyes. He says it emitted a shriek he compared to the sound of train brakes.

Then it launched vertically into the sky.

[PAUSE]

Vertically.

I keep coming back to that word across all of these accounts — Point Pleasant, 1966. Chicago, 2017 through 2020. The thing goes straight up.

No bird does that. A bird needs a run. A bird needs wind. A helicopter needs a rotor.

Whatever these people saw — and they are seeing something — they all use the same word for how it leaves.

Up.

[PAUSE]

By the time the Chicago investigation settled down around 2021, Lon Strickler had logged over 160 confirmed sightings across the greater Chicago area and the surrounding Upper Midwest. Wisconsin. Indiana. Michigan across the lake.

A 250-mile radius around downtown Chicago.

Fifty years after Point Pleasant.

The skeptics will tell you — and they're not wrong — that most of what people describe can be explained by large birds seen in bad light, by expectant attention, by urban legends feeding themselves.

The ecologists will tell you that Chicago's wildlife is genuinely expanding into its urban environment. Great Blue Herons. Sandhill Cranes returning to areas where they haven't been seen in generations. In low light, at a distance, a seven-foot Great Blue Heron banking over a parking lot is a remarkable and startling sight.

I believe that explains some of what was seen.

Not all of it.

Because some of these accounts — the vertical launch, the sound like metal brakes, the upright bipedal posture, the eyes that don't just glow but focus — those details don't fit what herons do.

And I can't tell you what does fit.

— CHAPTER 7: OUTRO —

[MUSIC IN — same atmospheric theme as the cold open. Quieter. End of the night.]

[MUSIC UNDER]

Point Pleasant had a year of warnings. Whether the warnings meant anything — that's yours to decide.

I'll tell you where I land.

I think something happened in that town. I think real people had real encounters with something they couldn't explain. I think some of those encounters were probably large birds in bad light. I think some of them were amplified by fear and community contagion.

And I think some of them were something else.

I can't tell you what. Nobody can. Not honestly.

But here's the thing about the Mothman that I can't shake, and it keeps me in this story after all the research is done:

Forty-six people went into the Ohio River on December 15th, 1967, and the thing that may or may not have been warning them — for thirteen months, in a hundred different sightings, hovering over that town — stopped showing up the same night they did.

Maybe that's coincidence.

Maybe coincidence is the most comforting word we have for things we can't explain.

I want to believe there's more to this world than what we can see and measure. Not because I'm afraid of the facts — I like the facts. I showed you all of them tonight.

But because the facts, laid end to end, still leave a gap.

And something lives in that gap.

I don't know what it is.

But I'm going to keep looking.

[PAUSE]

Keep the log open.

I'll see you in the dark.

[MUSIC UP — brief swell, then fade]

— END CREDITS / CTA —

[MUSIC UNDER — low]

That's Episode 1 of The Midnight Visitor Log. I'm your host. This is Lithium Dreams Industries.

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The video version of this episode — with B-roll, archival photographs, and the on-camera segments — lives on our YouTube channel at @LithiumDreamsTV.

Our website is [lithium-dreams.com](http://lithium-dreams.com) — that's where you'll find show notes, source lists, and information about the physical museum exhibit. The Mothman case file has its own room at the Last Roadside Attraction. If you're in the area, come find it.

Leave a review if you're willing. Tell one person. That's how the log stays open.

Next time on The Midnight Visitor Log...

[MUSIC OUT]

[END]

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#### PODCAST PRODUCTION NOTES

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##### RECORDING NOTES:

- No mic effects, no reverb, no processing that suggests a "spooky podcast." Dry vocal. This is a person talking to you, not a performance of mystery.
- Witness quotes: slight pullback on the level — not a different voice, just a subtle signal that these aren't the host's words. Let them land.
- The Joe Bob aside (theory section) should sound slightly off-script — a little faster, a little looser. If it sounds rehearsed, re-record it.

##### MUSIC BED NOTES:

- The atmospheric theme should not have any musical "jump scare" elements. No sudden swells when the bridge falls. The tragedy should land on silence, not on a musical sting.
- Ambient beds should be low enough that they're felt, not heard. The voice is the show.

##### SPONSOR BREAK PLACEMENT RATIONALE:

- Break 1 (after Act I): Natural transition into the sightings. Listener is engaged and oriented. Good time to hold attention through a brief interruption.
- Break 2 (after Science Break): The bridge has just fallen and the science section has provided an intellectual counterweight. Before moving into theories and Chicago, a break gives the listener a moment to process. The emotional weight of the bridge section earns the pause.



#### CHAPTER TIMESTAMPS:

- Record without breaks first, then note real timestamps for chapter markers. The above estimates are based on measured read-through pace.

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